- It reduces the complexity of nature of data and renders the data to comprehend easily.
- It enables proper utilization of data for further statistical treatment.

3.2 Types of Classification

The raw data can be classified in various ways depending on the nature of data. The general types of classification are: (i) Classification by Time or Chronological Classification (ii) Classification by Space or Spatial Classification (iii) Classification by Attribute or Qualitative Classification and (iv) Classification by Size or Quantitative Classification. Each of these types is now described.

3.2.1 Classification by Time or Chronological Classification

The method of classifying data according to time component is known as classification by time or chronological classification. In this type of classification, the groups or classes are arranged either in the ascending order or in the descending order with reference to time such as years, quarters, months, weeks, days, etc. Illustrations for statistical data to be classified under this type are listed below:

- Number of new schools established in Tamil Nadu during 1995 – 2015
- Pass percentage of students in SSLC Board Examinations over a period of past 5 years
- Index of market prices in stock exchanges arranged day-wise
- Month-wise salary particulars of employees in an industry
- Particulars of outpatients in a Primary Health Centre presented day-wise.

Example 3.1

The classification of data relating to the price of 10 gms of gold in India during 2001 - 2012 is given in Table 3.1

Table 3.1

Price of 10 gms of Gold in India

Year	Price in ₹	Year	Price in ₹	Year	Price in ₹
2001	4300	2005	7000	2009	14500
2002	4990	2006	8400	2010	18500
2003	5600	2007	10800	2011	26400
2004	5850	2008	12500	2012	31799

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